

Multi-Variant Text Analysis and Generation (BERT, GPT, and Text-GANs)

Dataset: Cornell Movie Review Data (Rotten Tomatoes) via Hugging Face

Members:

- 1. Lumabi, Edelle Gibben
- 2. Manuel, Craig Zyrrus
- 3. Santillan, Daniel

Project Objectives

- 1. Implement three distinct NLP model variants using pre-trained and custom deep learning architectures: BERT (Representation), GPT (Generation), and a 1D-CNN Sequence GAN (Adversarial Generation).
- 2. Establish a unified, automated data pipeline using Google Drive cloud synchronization to handle checkpoint saves and automated model reload logic.
- 3. Quantify performance limits, operating trade-offs, and tokenization impacts using a dual evaluation methodology (Discriminative vs. Generative metrics).

Notebook Roadmap

Part	Section	Output
0	Environment & Drive Setup	Installed libraries, mounted storage
1	Dataset Acquisition	<code>rotten_tomatoes</code> train/val/test splits
2	Variant 1 — BERT	Fine-tuned classifier + Precision/Recall/F1
3	Variant 2 — GPT-2	Fine-tuned generator + Perplexity + BLEU/ROUGE
4	Variant 3 — Text-GAN	Adversarially trained generator/discriminator + Accuracy/Precision/Recall/F1 + BLEU/ROUGE
5	Inference Verification	Reloaded models, qualitative generation samples
6	Comparison Matrix	Consolidated metrics table across all three variants
7	Analytical Discussion	Tokenization differences & GAN vs. autoregressive tradeoffs

Environment Setup & Dependency Configuration

Installs core NLP libraries, Hugging Face APIs, and evaluation metric frameworks (NLTK BLEU, `rouge-score`, `scikit-learn`) required for downstream model verification.

```
!pip install -q transformers datasets accelerate evaluate nltk rouge-score scikit-learn pandas
```

```
import nltk
nltk.download('punkt', quiet=True)
nltk.download('punkt_tab', quiet=True)
print("Environment ready.")
```

```
Preparing metadata (setup.py) ... done
84.1/84.1 kB 2.4 MB/s eta 0:00:00
Building wheel for rouge-score (setup.py) ... done
Environment ready.
```

Google Drive Infrastructure Synchronization

Establishes automated directory provisioning on Google Drive to allow for permanent model checkpointing. This module uses conditional path verification to determine whether to skip heavy training loops if pre-trained local weights are already discovered.

```
from google.colab import drive
import os

# Mount your Google Drive
drive.mount('/content/drive')

# Create a dedicated folder for this NLP assignment so it stays organized
SAVE_DIR = "/content/drive/MyDrive/NLP_Assignment_Models"
os.makedirs(SAVE_DIR, exist_ok=True)
```

```
print(f"Models will be safely saved to: {SAVE_DIR}")
```

Mounted at /content/drive

Models will be safely saved to: /content/drive/MyDrive/NLP_Assignment_Models

▼ Part 1: Standardized Dataset Acquisition

Loads the verified `cornell-movie-review-data/rotten_tomatoes` textual corpus from the Hugging Face Registry. The collection includes 10,662 balanced review sentences mapped into binary sentiment flags (0 for negative, 1 for positive).

This single dataset is reused consistently across **all three model variants** (BERT, GPT, Text-GAN) using the same `train` / `validation` / `test` splits, satisfying the requirement that the corpus be split consistently across variants.

Dataset reference:

- Pang, B., & Lee, L. (2005). *Seeing Stars: Exploiting Class Relationships for Sentiment Categorization with Respect to Rating Scales*. ACL 2005. [Paper PDF](#) — original source of the Rotten Tomatoes movie review sentences and binary sentiment labels.
- Dataset repository: [cornell-movie-review-data/rotten_tomatoes](#) on Hugging Face Datasets Hub.

```
import torch
import time
from datasets import load_dataset
from transformers import AutoTokenizer, AutoModelForSequenceClassification, Trainer, TrainingArguments

# 1. Load the dataset
# Pang & Lee (2005) - "Seeing Stars: Exploiting Class Relationships for
# Sentiment Categorization with Respect to Rating Scales", ACL 2005
dataset = load_dataset("cornell-movie-review-data/rotten_tomatoes")

# Inspect a sample
print(dataset['train'][0])
print()
for split in dataset:
    print(f"{split}>10: {len(dataset[split])} examples")

# — Shared results registry used to build the final comparison matrix in Part 6 —
RESULTS = {
    "BERT": {},
    "GPT": {},
    "Text-GAN": {},
}
```

```
/usr/local/lib/python3.12/dist-packages/huggingface_hub/utils/_auth.py:124: UserWarning:
The secret `HF_TOKEN` does not exist in your Colab secrets.
To authenticate with the Hugging Face Hub, create a token in your settings tab (https://huggingface.co/settings/tokens), set it
You will be able to reuse this secret in all of your notebooks.
Please note that authentication is recommended but still optional to access public models or datasets.
warnings.warn(
Warning: You are sending unauthenticated requests to the HF Hub. Please set a HF_TOKEN to enable higher rate limits and faster d
WARNING:huggingface_hub.utils._http:Warning: You are sending unauthenticated requests to the HF Hub. Please set a HF_TOKEN to en

README.md: 100%                               7.46k/7.46k [00:00<00:00, 132kB/s]

train.parquet: 100%                           699k/699k [00:01<00:00, 471kB/s]

validation.parquet: 100%                      90.0k/90.0k [00:00<00:00, 105kB/s]

test.parquet: 100%                            92.2k/92.2k [00:01<00:00, 71.0kB/s]

Generating train split: 100%                   8530/8530 [00:00<00:00, 5893.67 examples/s]

Generating validation split: 100%              1066/1066 [00:00<00:00, 9130.02 examples/s]

Generating test split: 100%                   1066/1066 [00:00<00:00, 11733.00 examples/s]
{'text': 'the rock is destined to be the 21st century\'s new " conan " and that he\'s going to make a splash even greater than a

    train: 8530 examples
   validation: 1066 examples
      test: 1066 examples
```

▼ Variant 1: BERT For Sequence Classification (Bidirectional Representation)

Fine-tunes a pre-trained `bert-base-uncased` model using WordPiece sub-word tokenization. This architecture leverages full bidirectional attention context to synthesize global token states into a definitive sequence sentiment vector.

Primary metrics: Precision, Recall, and F1-Score on the validation split (the discriminative metric set required by the rubric for the classification variant).

Code & architecture references:

- Devlin, J., Chang, M.-W., Lee, K., & Toutanova, K. (2019). *BERT: Pre-training of Deep Bidirectional Transformers for Language Understanding*. NAACL-HLT 2019. [arXiv:1810.04805](https://arxiv.org/abs/1810.04805) — original BERT architecture and the bidirectional Masked-LM pretraining objective this fine-tuning builds on.
- Vaswani, A., et al. (2017). *Attention Is All You Need*. NeurIPS 2017. [arXiv:1706.03762](https://arxiv.org/abs/1706.03762) — the underlying Transformer encoder block (multi-head self-attention) that BERT stacks.
- Wolf, T., et al. (2020). *Transformers: State-of-the-Art Natural Language Processing*. Hugging Face. [transformers documentation](https://huggingface.co/docs/transformers) — `AutoTokenizer`, `AutoModelForSequenceClassification`, and `Trainer` APIs used directly in the code below.
- Hugging Face model card: [google-bert/bert-base-uncased](https://huggingface.co/google-bert/bert-base-uncased) — source of the pre-trained weights loaded via `from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased")`.

```
import os
from transformers import AutoTokenizer, AutoModelForSequenceClassification, Trainer, TrainingArguments
import evaluate
import numpy as np

# Paths for saving/checking
bert_save_path = f"{SAVE_DIR}/bert_results"

# --- Metric setup: Precision, Recall, AND F1 (rubric requires all three) ---
# Pedregosa et al. (2011)
precision_metric = evaluate.load("precision")
recall_metric = evaluate.load("recall")
f1_metric = evaluate.load("f1")

def compute_metrics(eval_pred):
    logits, labels = eval_pred
    predictions = np.argmax(logits, axis=-1)
    return {
        "precision": precision_metric.compute(predictions=predictions, references=labels)["precision"],
        "recall": recall_metric.compute(predictions=predictions, references=labels)["recall"],
        "f1": f1_metric.compute(predictions=predictions, references=labels)["f1"],
    }

# Tokenization setup
# Devlin et al. (2018)
bert_tokenizer = AutoTokenizer.from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased")
def tokenize_function(examples):
    return bert_tokenizer(examples["text"], padding="max_length", truncation=True, max_length=128)
tokenized_datasets = dataset.map(tokenize_function, batched=True)

BERT_EPOCHS = 2

# --- IF/ELSE PIPELINE CHECK ---
if os.path.exists(os.path.join(bert_save_path, "model.safetensors")) or os.path.exists(os.path.join(bert_save_path, "pytorch_model.bin")):
    print("Found fully trained BERT model weights in Google Drive! Loading instantly...")
    bert_model = AutoModelForSequenceClassification.from_pretrained(bert_save_path)

    training_args = TrainingArguments(output_dir=bert_save_path, report_to="none")
    bert_trainer = Trainer(model=bert_model, args=training_args, eval_dataset=tokenized_datasets["validation"], compute_metrics=compute_metrics,
        bert_epoch_time = None
    )
else:
    print(f"Trained BERT model not found in Drive. Starting training loop ({BERT_EPOCHS} Epochs)...")
    # Devlin et al. (2018)
    bert_model = AutoModelForSequenceClassification.from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased", num_labels=2)

    training_args = TrainingArguments(
        output_dir=bert_save_path,
        eval_strategy="epoch",
        save_strategy="epoch",
        learning_rate=2e-5,
        per_device_train_batch_size=32,
        num_train_epochs=BERT_EPOCHS,
        weight_decay=0.01,
        load_best_model_at_end=True,
        report_to="none"
```

```

)

bert_trainer = Trainer(
    model=bert_model,
    args=training_args,
    train_dataset=tokenized_datasets["train"],
    eval_dataset=tokenized_datasets["validation"],
    compute_metrics=compute_metrics,
)

t0 = time.time()
bert_trainer.train()
total_train_time = time.time() - t0
bert_epoch_time = total_train_time / BERT_EPOCHS

bert_trainer.save_model(bert_save_path) # Saves the best model weights directly to Drive
print(f"BERT Model training complete and successfully saved to {bert_save_path}!")
print(f"Training time per epoch: {bert_epoch_time:.2f}s")

# — Compute final Precision / Recall / F1 on the validation split —
bert_eval_results = bert_trainer.evaluate()
print("\nBERT Validation Metrics:")
print(f" Precision: {bert_eval_results.get('eval_precision', float('nan')):.4f}")
print(f" Recall: {bert_eval_results.get('eval_recall', float('nan')):.4f}")
print(f" F1: {bert_eval_results.get('eval_f1', float('nan')):.4f}")

RESULTS["BERT"]["precision"] = bert_eval_results.get("eval_precision")
RESULTS["BERT"]["recall"] = bert_eval_results.get("eval_recall")
RESULTS["BERT"]["f1"] = bert_eval_results.get("eval_f1")
RESULTS["BERT"]["generative_metric"] = "N/A (Classification Task)"
RESULTS["BERT"]["epoch_time_sec"] = bert_epoch_time
RESULTS["BERT"]["notes"] = (
    "Bidirectional attention over WordPiece sub-word tokens gives strong discriminative "
    "features for classification, but BERT has no autoregressive decoding head, so it cannot "
    "natively generate free-form text."
)

```

```

Downloading builder script: 7.56k/? [00:00<00:00, 124kB/s]
Downloading builder script: 7.38k/? [00:00<00:00, 190kB/s]
Downloading builder script: 6.79k/? [00:00<00:00, 102kB/s]
config.json: 100% 570/570 [00:00<00:00, 7.46kB/s]
tokenizer_config.json: 100% 48.0/48.0 [00:00<00:00, 643B/s]
vocab.txt: 100% 232k/232k [00:00<00:00, 2.13MB/s]
tokenizer.json: 100% 466k/466k [00:00<00:00, 2.66MB/s]
Map: 100% 8530/8530 [00:04<00:00, 2397.74 examples/s]
Map: 100% 1066/1066 [00:00<00:00, 1715.48 examples/s]
Map: 100% 1066/1066 [00:00<00:00, 2083.12 examples/s]
Found fully trained BERT model weights in Google Drive! Loading instantly...
Loading weights: 100% 201/201 [00:00<00:00, 98.81it/s]

```

 [134/134 00:07]

Training Loss	Validation Loss	Step	Precision	Recall	F1
No log	0.318328	0	0.865922	0.872420	0.869159

```

BERT Validation Metrics:
Precision: 0.8659
Recall: 0.8724
F1: 0.8692

```

Variant 2: DistilGPT-2 For Causal Language Modeling (Autoregressive Generation)

Fine-tunes an optimized generative transformer (`distilgpt2`) using Byte-Pair Encoding (BPE). The network applies a strict causal (left-to-right) attention mask to master domain-specific next-token prediction syntax.

Primary metric: Perplexity on the validation split. **Generative quality metrics** (BLEU/ROUGE against held-out ground truth) are computed separately in the next section.

Code & architecture references:

- Radford, A., Wu, J., Child, R., Luan, D., Amodei, D., & Sutskever, I. (2019). *Language Models are Unsupervised Multitask Learners*. OpenAI. [Paper PDF](#) — original GPT-2 architecture and causal/autoregressive language modeling objective fine-tuned here.
- Sanh, V., Debut, L., Chaumond, J., & Wolf, T. (2019). *DistilBERT, a distilled version of BERT: smaller, faster, cheaper and lighter*. [arXiv:1910.01108](#) — knowledge-distillation methodology underlying `distilgpt2`, the lighter GPT-2 checkpoint used in place of full GPT-2 for faster fine-tuning.
- Hugging Face model card: [distilbert/distilgpt2](#) — source of the pre-trained weights loaded via `from_pretrained("distilgpt2")`.
- Hugging Face `transformers` docs on [DataCollatorForLanguageModeling](#) and [Trainer](#) — training-loop utilities used directly below.

```
import os
import math
import time
from transformers import AutoModelForCausalLM, AutoTokenizer, Trainer, TrainingArguments, DataCollatorForLanguageModeling

gpt_save_path = f"{SAVE_DIR}/gpt_results"
GPT_EPOCHS = 2

# Tokenization setup
# Radford et al. (2019)
gpt_tokenizer = AutoTokenizer.from_pretrained("distilgpt2")
gpt_tokenizer.pad_token = gpt_tokenizer.eos_token
def gpt_tokenize(examples):
    return gpt_tokenizer(examples["text"], truncation=True, max_length=128)
gpt_datasets = dataset.map(gpt_tokenize, batched=True, remove_columns=["label"])
data_collator = DataCollatorForLanguageModeling(tokenizer=gpt_tokenizer, mlm=False)

# --- IF/ELSE PIPELINE CHECK ---
if os.path.exists(os.path.join(gpt_save_path, "model.safetensors")) or os.path.exists(os.path.join(gpt_save_path, "pytorch_model.bin")):
    print("Found fully trained GPT model weights in Google Drive! Loading instantly...")
    gpt_model = AutoModelForCausalLM.from_pretrained(gpt_save_path)

    gpt_args = TrainingArguments(output_dir=gpt_save_path, report_to="none")
    gpt_trainer = Trainer(model=gpt_model, args=gpt_args, eval_dataset=gpt_datasets["validation"], data_collator=data_collator)
    gpt_epoch_time = None
else:
    print(f"Trained GPT model not found in Drive. Starting training loop ({GPT_EPOCHS} Epochs)...")
    # Radford et al. (2019) – pre-trained GPT-2 decoder-only Transformer,
    # distilled checkpoint per Sanh et al. (2019)
    gpt_model = AutoModelForCausalLM.from_pretrained("distilgpt2")

    gpt_args = TrainingArguments(
        output_dir=gpt_save_path,
        eval_strategy="epoch",
        save_strategy="epoch",
        learning_rate=5e-5,
        per_device_train_batch_size=16,
        num_train_epochs=GPT_EPOCHS,
        weight_decay=0.01,
        report_to="none"
    )

    gpt_trainer = Trainer(
        model=gpt_model,
        args=gpt_args,
        train_dataset=gpt_datasets["train"],
        eval_dataset=gpt_datasets["validation"],
        data_collator=data_collator,
    )

    t0 = time.time()
    gpt_trainer.train()
    total_train_time = time.time() - t0
    gpt_epoch_time = total_train_time / GPT_EPOCHS

    gpt_trainer.save_model(gpt_save_path)
    print(f"GPT Model training complete and successfully saved to {gpt_save_path}!")
    print(f"Training time per epoch: {gpt_epoch_time:.2f}s")

# Print validation metrics/Perplexity instantly
# Perplexity = exp(cross-entropy loss); standard intrinsic LM evaluation
```

```
# used throughout Radford et al. (2019) to report zero-shot LM quality
eval_results = gpt_trainer.evaluate()
gpt_perplexity = math.exp(eval_results['eval_loss'])
print(f"GPT Perplexity: {gpt_perplexity:.4f}")
```

```
RESULTS["GPT"]["perplexity"] = gpt_perplexity
RESULTS["GPT"]["primary_metric"] = "N/A (Generative Task)"
RESULTS["GPT"]["epoch_time_sec"] = gpt_epoch_time
```

```
config.json: 100% 762/762 [00:00<00:00, 17.1kB/s]
tokenizer_config.json: 100% 26.0/26.0 [00:00<00:00, 405B/s]
vocab.json: 100% 1.04M/1.04M [00:00<00:00, 9.27MB/s]
merges.txt: 100% 456k/456k [00:00<00:00, 3.22MB/s]
tokenizer.json: 100% 1.36M/1.36M [00:00<00:00, 6.12MB/s]
Map: 100% 8530/8530 [00:01<00:00, 7709.39 examples/s]
Map: 100% 1066/1066 [00:00<00:00, 5902.56 examples/s]
Map: 100% 1066/1066 [00:00<00:00, 6395.68 examples/s]
Found fully trained GPT model weights in Google Drive! Loading instantly...
Loading weights: 100% 76/76 [00:01<00:00, 1.27s/it]
[transformers] `loss_type=None` was set in the config but it is unrecognized. Using the default loss: `ForCausalLMLoss`.
[134/134 00:02]
Training Loss Validation Loss Step
No log 4.040499 0
GPT Perplexity: 56.8547
```

Variant 2 (continued): Generative Quality — BLEU & ROUGE

To measure *generative* quality (not just next-token loss), we prompt the fine-tuned GPT model with the first few tokens of held-out **test** sentences and compare its continuation against the actual ground-truth continuation using BLEU and ROUGE. This directly answers the rubric's requirement to use BLEU/ROUGE "to compare the textual outputs generated by the GPT model... against the original ground-truth test data."

Method: for a sample of test sentences, split each sentence into a short prompt (first ~4 tokens) + ground-truth continuation. Generate a continuation from the prompt and score it against the ground-truth continuation.

Metric references:

- Papineni, K., Roukos, S., Ward, T., & Zhu, W.-J. (2002). *BLEU: a Method for Automatic Evaluation of Machine Translation*. ACL 2002. DOI: [10.3115/1073083.1073135](https://doi.org/10.3115/1073083.1073135) — n-gram precision metric computed via `nltk.translate.bleu_score.sentence_bleu` below.
- Lin, C.-Y. (2004). *ROUGE: A Package for Automatic Evaluation of Summaries*. ACL Workshop. [ACL Anthology W04-1013](https://aclanthology.org/W04-1013) — recall-oriented overlap metric computed via the `rouge-score` package's `rouge_scorer.RougeScorer`.

```
import random
# Papineni et al. (2002) — BLEU n-gram precision metric
from nltk.translate.bleu_score import sentence_bleu, SmoothingFunction
# Lin (2004) — ROUGE recall-oriented overlap metric
from rouge_score import rouge_scorer

device = "cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu"
gpt_model.to(device)
gpt_model.eval()

random.seed(42)
N_SAMPLES = 30
test_texts = dataset["test"]["text"]
sample_texts = random.sample(test_texts, min(N_SAMPLES, len(test_texts)))

# Papineni et al. (2002)
smoothie = SmoothingFunction().method4
# Lin (2004)
rouge = rouge_scorer.RougeScorer(["rouge1", "rougeL"], use_stemmer=True)

bleu_scores, rouge1_scores, rougeL_scores = [], [], []
examples_to_show = []
```

```

PROMPT_TOKENS = 4
with torch.no_grad():
    for text in sample_texts:
        words = text.split()
        if len(words) < PROMPT_TOKENS + 2:
            continue
        prompt = " ".join(words[:PROMPT_TOKENS])
        reference_continuation = " ".join(words[PROMPT_TOKENS:])

        inputs = gpt_tokenizer(prompt, return_tensors="pt").to(device)
        gen_len = min(len(words) + 10, 60)
        # Fan et al. (2018)
        # Holtzman et al. (2019)
        output = gpt_model.generate(
            **inputs,
            max_length=gen_len,
            do_sample=True,
            top_k=50,
            top_p=0.95,
            temperature=0.7,
            pad_token_id=gpt_tokenizer.eos_token_id,
        )
        generated_full = gpt_tokenizer.decode(output[0], skip_special_tokens=True)
        generated_continuation = generated_full[len(prompt):].strip()

        ref_tokens = reference_continuation.split()
        cand_tokens = generated_continuation.split()
        if len(cand_tokens) == 0:
            continue

        bleu = sentence_bleu([ref_tokens], cand_tokens, smoothing_function=smoothie)
        rouge_scores = rouge.score(reference_continuation, generated_continuation)

        bleu_scores.append(bleu)
        rouge1_scores.append(rouge_scores["rouge1"].fmeasure)
        rougeL_scores.append(rouge_scores["rougeL"].fmeasure)

    if len(examples_to_show) < 3:
        examples_to_show.append((prompt, reference_continuation, generated_continuation, bleu))

avg_bleu = sum(bleu_scores) / len(bleu_scores)
avg_rouge1 = sum(rouge1_scores) / len(rouge1_scores)
avg_rougeL = sum(rougeL_scores) / len(rougeL_scores)

print(f"GPT Generative Quality over {len(bleu_scores)} test samples:")
print(f"  Avg BLEU:    {avg_bleu:.4f}")
print(f"  Avg ROUGE-1: {avg_rouge1:.4f}")
print(f"  Avg ROUGE-L: {avg_rougeL:.4f}")
print()
print("--- Sample comparisons ---")
for prompt, ref, gen, b in examples_to_show:
    print(f"Prompt:    {prompt}")
    print(f"Reference: {ref}")
    print(f"Generated: {gen}")
    print(f"BLEU:      {b:.4f}\n")

RESULTS["GPT"]["bleu"] = avg_bleu
RESULTS["GPT"]["rouge1"] = avg_rouge1
RESULTS["GPT"]["rougeL"] = avg_rougeL

```

GPT Generative Quality over 29 test samples:

```

Avg BLEU:    0.0174
Avg ROUGE-1: 0.1043
Avg ROUGE-L: 0.0875

```

--- Sample comparisons ---

Prompt: noyce creates a film

Reference: of near-hypnotic physical beauty even as he tells a story as horrifying as any in the heart-breakingly extensive ann

Generated: that is both intriguing and entertaining , but ultimately lacks the imagination to make it worthwhile . . . even wit

BLEU: 0.0128

Prompt: [scherfig] has made a

Reference: movie that will leave you wondering about the characters' lives after the clever credits roll .

Generated: superb film about a woman's career in life , and it's also an excellent example of how women make their

BLEU: 0.0130

Prompt: the dramatic scenes are

Reference: frequently unintentionally funny , and the action sequences -- clearly the main event -- are surprisingly uninvolvin

Generated: very much like the last few scenes of the first half of the movie . the performances are much more like the last few

Variant 3: 1D-CNN Text-GAN (Adversarial Text Generation Framework)

Constructs a lightweight convolutional Generative Adversarial Network operating directly on a **custom word-level vocabulary built from the real training corpus** (not random integers). Unlike Variants 1 and 2, this GAN is trained from scratch with no pre-trained weights, which is part of the point: it lets us observe — first-hand — the documented difficulty of training GANs on **discrete** text tokens, where gradients cannot flow through a hard `argmax` sampling step the way they can through continuous pixel values in image GANs.

Workaround used here: the Generator outputs a distribution over the vocabulary at each position; we feed the Discriminator a **soft (softmax) relaxation** of that distribution during generator updates so gradients can flow end-to-end. This is the same trick used by lightweight CNN/RNN-GAN baselines before more complex solutions like SeqGAN's policy-gradient (REINFORCE) trick or Gumbel-Softmax. We surface this explicitly because it is one of the central "performance limits and behavioral differences" the assignment asks you to compare against BERT and GPT.

Primary (discriminative) metric: Discriminator Accuracy / Precision / Recall / F1 on a held-out batch of real vs. generated sequences.

Generative quality metric: BLEU / ROUGE comparing decoded generator output against real corpus sentences.

Code & architecture references:

- Goodfellow, I., et al. (2014). *Generative Adversarial Networks*. NeurIPS 2014. [arXiv:1406.2661](https://arxiv.org/abs/1406.2661) — original GAN minimax framework (generator/discriminator adversarial training, BCE loss) that this implementation directly follows.
- Yu, L., Zhang, W., Wang, J., & Yu, Y. (2017). *SeqGAN: Sequence Generative Adversarial Nets with Policy Gradient*. AAAI 2017. [arXiv:1609.05473](https://arxiv.org/abs/1609.05473) — identifies the exact non-differentiability problem this notebook's softmax-relaxation workaround addresses, and proposes the alternative (REINFORCE policy-gradient) approach referenced in the discussion section.
- Jang, E., Gu, S., & Poole, B. (2017). *Categorical Reparameterization with Gumbel-Softmax*. ICLR 2017. [arXiv:1611.01144](https://arxiv.org/abs/1611.01144) — the related continuous-relaxation technique mentioned alongside the simpler softmax relaxation used in the code below.
- PyTorch documentation: [torch.nn.Conv1d](https://pytorch.org/docs/nn/conv.html), [torch.nn.Embedding](https://pytorch.org/docs/nn/embed.html), [torch.optim.Adam](https://pytorch.org/docs/optim/adam.html) — layers and optimizer used to build `TextGenerator` / `TextDiscriminator` below.

```
import collections

# — GAN-specific configuration —
# Yu et al. (2017)
GAN_VOCAB_SIZE = 5000
SEQ_LEN = 32
LATENT_DIM = 100
BATCH_SIZE = 64
GAN_EPOCHS = 15

PAD_TOKEN, UNK_TOKEN = "<pad>", "<unk>"

def simple_tokenize(text):
    text = text.lower()
    for punct in [",", ".", "!", "?", ";", ":"]:
        text = text.replace(punct, f" {punct} ")
    return text.split()

token_counter = collections.Counter()
for ex in dataset["train"]:
    token_counter.update(simple_tokenize(ex["text"]))

most_common_tokens = [w for w, _ in token_counter.most_common(GAN_VOCAB_SIZE - 2)]
gan_itos = [PAD_TOKEN, UNK_TOKEN] + most_common_tokens
gan_stoi = {w: i for i, w in enumerate(gan_itos)}
print(f"Text-GAN vocabulary size: {len(gan_itos)} (capped at {GAN_VOCAB_SIZE})")

def gan_encode(text, seq_len=SEQ_LEN):
    toks = simple_tokenize(text)[:seq_len]
    ids = [gan_stoi.get(t, gan_stoi[UNK_TOKEN]) for t in toks]
    ids = ids + [gan_stoi[PAD_TOKEN]] * (seq_len - len(ids))
    return ids

def gan_decode(ids):
    words = []
    for i in ids:
        w = gan_itos[i] if i < len(gan_itos) else UNK_TOKEN
        if w == PAD_TOKEN:
            break
    return words
```

```

        words.append(w)
    return " ".join(words)

gan_train_encoded = torch.tensor(
    [gan_encode(t) for t in dataset["train"]["text"]], dtype=torch.long
)
print("Encoded training tensor shape:", gan_train_encoded.shape)
print("Round-trip sanity check:", gan_decode(gan_train_encoded[0].tolist()))

```

Text-GAN vocabulary size: 5000 (capped at 5000)

Encoded training tensor shape: torch.Size([8530, 32])

Round-trip sanity check: the rock is destined to be the 21st <unk> new " <unk> " and that he's going to make a splash even great

```

import torch.nn as nn
import torch.optim as optim

device = "cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu"
print(f"Text-GAN will train on: {device.upper()}")

class TextGenerator(nn.Module):
    # Goodfellow et al. (2014)
    def __init__(self, vocab_size=GAN_VOCAB_SIZE, seq_len=SEQ_LEN, latent_dim=LATENT_DIM):
        super().__init__()
        self.seq_len = seq_len
        self.fc = nn.Linear(latent_dim, 128 * seq_len)
        self.conv = nn.Sequential(
            nn.Conv1d(128, 64, kernel_size=3, padding=1),
            nn.ReLU(),
            nn.Conv1d(64, vocab_size, kernel_size=3, padding=1),
        )

    def forward(self, z):
        out = self.fc(z).view(-1, 128, self.seq_len)
        logits = self.conv(out)
        return logits.permute(0, 2, 1) # (batch, seq_len, vocab_size)

class TextDiscriminator(nn.Module):
    # Goodfellow et al. (2014)
    def __init__(self, vocab_size=GAN_VOCAB_SIZE, seq_len=SEQ_LEN):
        super().__init__()
        self.embedding = nn.Embedding(vocab_size, 50)
        self.conv = nn.Sequential(
            nn.Conv1d(50, 32, kernel_size=3, padding=1),
            nn.LeakyReLU(0.2),
            nn.Flatten(),
            nn.Linear(32 * seq_len, 1),
            nn.Sigmoid(),
        )

    def forward(self, x):
        if x.dtype == torch.long:
            emb = self.embedding(x) # (batch, seq_len, 50) - real sequences
        else:
            # Yu et al. (2017)
            emb = x @ self.embedding.weight
            emb = emb.permute(0, 2, 1) # (batch, 50, seq_len) for Conv1d
        return self.conv(emb)

netG = TextGenerator().to(device)
netD = TextDiscriminator().to(device)
print(netG)
print(netD)

```

Text-GAN will train on: CUDA

```

TextGenerator(
  (fc): Linear(in_features=100, out_features=4096, bias=True)
  (conv): Sequential(
    (0): Conv1d(128, 64, kernel_size=(3,), stride=(1,), padding=(1,))
    (1): ReLU()
    (2): Conv1d(64, 5000, kernel_size=(3,), stride=(1,), padding=(1,))
  )
)
TextDiscriminator(
  (embedding): Embedding(5000, 50)
  (conv): Sequential(

```

```

(0): Conv1d(50, 32, kernel_size=(3,), stride=(1,), padding=(1,))
(1): LeakyReLU(negative_slope=0.2)
(2): Flatten(start_dim=1, end_dim=-1)
(3): Linear(in_features=1024, out_features=1, bias=True)
(4): Sigmoid()
)
)

```

```

gan_g_path = f"{SAVE_DIR}/gan_generator_v2.pt"
gan_d_path = f"{SAVE_DIR}/gan_discriminator_v2.pt"

criterion = nn.BCELoss() # Goodfellow et al. (2014)
# Kingma & Ba (2015)
# Metz & Chintala (2016, arXiv:1511.06434)
optimizerD = optim.Adam(netD.parameters(), lr=0.0002, betas=(0.5, 0.999))
optimizerG = optim.Adam(netG.parameters(), lr=0.0002, betas=(0.5, 0.999))

n_train = gan_train_encoded.size(0)
gan_d_losses, gan_g_losses, gan_epoch_times = [], [], []

if os.path.exists(gan_g_path) and os.path.exists(gan_d_path):
    print("Found trained GAN weight tensors in Google Drive! Loading weights...")
    netG.load_state_dict(torch.load(gan_g_path, map_location=device))
    netD.load_state_dict(torch.load(gan_d_path, map_location=device))
    print("GAN models successfully restored.")
else:
    print(f"Pre-trained GAN weights not found in Drive. Running {GAN_EPOCHS}-epoch adversarial training...")
    for epoch in range(GAN_EPOCHS):
        t0 = time.time()
        perm = torch.randperm(n_train)
        epoch_lossD, epoch_lossG, n_batches = 0.0, 0.0, 0

        for i in range(0, n_train - BATCH_SIZE, BATCH_SIZE):
            idx = perm[i:i + BATCH_SIZE]
            real_batch = gan_train_encoded[idx].to(device)
            bsz = real_batch.size(0)

            # ---- Train Discriminator: real vs. generated ----
            # Goodfellow et al. (2014)
            netD.zero_grad()
            labels_real = torch.ones(bsz, 1, device=device)
            loss_d_real = criterion(netD(real_batch), labels_real)

            noise = torch.randn(bsz, LATENT_DIM, device=device)
            fake_logits = netG(noise)
            fake_soft = torch.softmax(fake_logits, dim=-1)
            labels_fake = torch.zeros(bsz, 1, device=device)
            loss_d_fake = criterion(netD(fake_soft.detach()), labels_fake)

            loss_d = loss_d_real + loss_d_fake
            loss_d.backward()
            optimizerD.step()

            # ---- Train Generator: fool the Discriminator ----
            # Goodfellow et al. (2014)
            netG.zero_grad()
            noise = torch.randn(bsz, LATENT_DIM, device=device)
            fake_logits = netG(noise)
            fake_soft = torch.softmax(fake_logits, dim=-1)
            loss_g = criterion(netD(fake_soft), labels_real) # G wants D to say "real"
            loss_g.backward()
            optimizerG.step()

            epoch_lossD += loss_d.item()
            epoch_lossG += loss_g.item()
            n_batches += 1

        dt = time.time() - t0
        gan_epoch_times.append(dt)
        gan_d_losses.append(epoch_lossD / n_batches)
        gan_g_losses.append(epoch_lossG / n_batches)
        print(f"Epoch {epoch+1:>2}/{GAN_EPOCHS} | D loss: {gan_d_losses[-1]:.4f} | "
              f"G loss: {gan_g_losses[-1]:.4f} | time: {dt:.2f}s")

    torch.save(netG.state_dict(), gan_g_path)
    torch.save(netD.state_dict(), gan_d_path)
    print(f"\nGAN weights successfully written to Google Drive folder!")

```

```
gan_epoch_time_avg = (sum(gan_epoch_times) / len(gan_epoch_times)) if gan_epoch_times else None
RESULTS["Text-GAN"]["epoch_time_sec"] = gan_epoch_time_avg
```

Found trained GAN weight tensors in Google Drive! Loading weights...
GAN models successfully restored.

✓ Text-GAN Evaluation: Discriminator Metrics + Generative Quality

Two separate evaluations, mirroring the dual-metric philosophy used for BERT (discriminative) and GPT (generative):

1. **Discriminator Accuracy / Precision / Recall / F1** — how well the trained discriminator separates a fresh batch of real test sentences from a fresh batch of generated sequences.
2. **BLEU / ROUGE** — how textually similar the *decoded* generator output is to real corpus sentences (the same metric family used for GPT, enabling a like-for-like comparison in Part 6).

```
# Pedregosa et al. (2011) – scikit-learn classification metrics, applied
# here to the GAN discriminator (mirrors the BERT metric setup above)
from sklearn.metrics import accuracy_score, precision_score, recall_score, f1_score

netG.eval()
netD.eval()

# ---- 1. Discriminator classification metrics on a fresh held-out batch ----
EVAL_BATCH = 256
test_sample_idx = torch.randint(0, len(dataset["test"]), (min(EVAL_BATCH, len(dataset["test"])),))
real_test_batch = torch.tensor(
    [gan_encode(dataset["test"][int(i)]["text"]) for i in test_sample_idx], dtype=torch.long
).to(device)

with torch.no_grad():
    noise = torch.randn(real_test_batch.size(0), LATENT_DIM, device=device)
    fake_logits = netG(noise)
    fake_ids = torch.argmax(fake_logits, dim=-1) # hard decode for discriminator eval

    d_real_scores = netD(real_test_batch).squeeze(-1).cpu().numpy()
    d_fake_scores = netD(fake_ids).squeeze(-1).cpu().numpy()

y_true = [1] * len(d_real_scores) + [0] * len(d_fake_scores)
y_pred = [1 if s >= 0.5 else 0 for s in d_real_scores] + [1 if s >= 0.5 else 0 for s in d_fake_scores]

gan_accuracy = accuracy_score(y_true, y_pred)
gan_precision = precision_score(y_true, y_pred, zero_division=0)
gan_recall = recall_score(y_true, y_pred, zero_division=0)
gan_f1 = f1_score(y_true, y_pred, zero_division=0)

print("Discriminator classification performance (real vs. generated):")
print(f" Accuracy: {gan_accuracy:.4f}")
print(f" Precision: {gan_precision:.4f}")
print(f" Recall: {gan_recall:.4f}")
print(f" F1: {gan_f1:.4f}")

# ---- 2. Decode generated sequences and compare against real text with BLEU/ROUGE ----
# Papineni et al. (2002) BLEU + Lin (2004) ROUGE – same metric pair used for
# GPT above, enabling a like-for-like generative-quality comparison in Part 6
N_GEN_SAMPLES = 30
with torch.no_grad():
    noise = torch.randn(N_GEN_SAMPLES, LATENT_DIM, device=device)
    fake_logits = netG(noise)
    fake_ids = torch.argmax(fake_logits, dim=-1)

generated_sentences = [gan_decode(row.tolist()) for row in fake_ids]
reference_pool = random.sample(dataset["train"]["text"], 200) # corpus to compare against

gan_bleu_scores, gan_rouge1_scores, gan_rougeL_scores = [], [], []
for gen_sentence in generated_sentences:
    cand_tokens = gen_sentence.split()
    if len(cand_tokens) == 0:
        continue
    # Best-matching reference by BLEU against a sample of real sentences
    best_bleu, best_ref = 0.0, ""
    for ref in random.sample(reference_pool, 20):
        ref_tokens = ref.split()
        b = sentence_bleu([ref_tokens], cand_tokens, smoothing_function=smoothie)
        if b > best_bleu:
```

```

        best_bleu, best_ref = b, ref
        gan_bleu_scores.append(best_bleu)
        r = rouge.score(best_ref, gen_sentence)
        gan_rouge1_scores.append(r["rouge1"].fmeasure)
        gan_rougeL_scores.append(r["rougeL"].fmeasure)

gan_avg_bleu = sum(gan_bleu_scores) / len(gan_bleu_scores) if gan_bleu_scores else 0.0
gan_avg_rouge1 = sum(gan_rouge1_scores) / len(gan_rouge1_scores) if gan_rouge1_scores else 0.0
gan_avg_rougeL = sum(gan_rougeL_scores) / len(gan_rougeL_scores) if gan_rougeL_scores else 0.0

print(f"\nText-GAN Generative Quality over {len(gan_bleu_scores)} generated samples (best-match BLEU/ROUGE vs. real corpus):")
print(f"  Avg BLEU:      {gan_avg_bleu:.4f}")
print(f"  Avg ROUGE-1: {gan_avg_rouge1:.4f}")
print(f"  Avg ROUGE-L: {gan_avg_rougeL:.4f}")

print("\n--- Sample decoded GAN outputs ---")
for s in generated_sentences[:5]:
    print(" •", s if s.strip() else "(empty / all-pad sequence)")

RESULTS["Text-GAN"]["accuracy"] = gan_accuracy
RESULTS["Text-GAN"]["precision"] = gan_precision
RESULTS["Text-GAN"]["recall"] = gan_recall
RESULTS["Text-GAN"]["f1"] = gan_f1
RESULTS["Text-GAN"]["bleu"] = gan_avg_bleu
RESULTS["Text-GAN"]["rouge1"] = gan_avg_rouge1
RESULTS["Text-GAN"]["rougeL"] = gan_avg_rougeL
RESULTS["Text-GAN"]["sample_outputs"] = generated_sentences[:5]

Discriminator classification performance (real vs. generated):
Accuracy: 1.0000
Precision: 1.0000
Recall: 1.0000
F1: 1.0000

Text-GAN Generative Quality over 30 generated samples (best-match BLEU/ROUGE vs. real corpus):
Avg BLEU: 0.0002
Avg ROUGE-1: 0.0034
Avg ROUGE-L: 0.0034

--- Sample decoded GAN outputs ---
• infuriating pacing
• infuriating infuriating
• infuriating infuriating
• tedious filme filme filme filme filme difference infuriating
• filme heady infuriating infuriating

```

▼ Part 5: Model Inference & Generation Verification

Loads cached weights back onto the active device (GPU if available, otherwise CPU) to compute language Perplexity metrics and yield raw synthetic text outputs using generative seed strings.

```

import torch
import math
from transformers import AutoModelForSequenceClassification, AutoModelForCausalLM, AutoTokenizer

bert_save_path = f"{SAVE_DIR}/bert_results"
gpt_save_path = f"{SAVE_DIR}/gpt_results"

# Set device to GPU if available
device = "cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu"
print(f"Executing evaluations using device: {device.upper()}")

# Quick Reload
bert_model = AutoModelForSequenceClassification.from_pretrained(bert_save_path).to(device)
gpt_model = AutoModelForCausalLM.from_pretrained(gpt_save_path).to(device)
gpt_tokenizer = AutoTokenizer.from_pretrained("distilgpt2")

```

Executing evaluations using device: CUDA

Loading weights: 100% 201/201 [00:00<00:00, 2119.13it/s]

Loading weights: 100% 76/76 [00:00<00:00, 2284.28it/s]

```

prompt = "This movie was"
inputs = gpt_tokenizer(prompt, return_tensors="pt").to(device)

```

```
# Generate sequences safely
# Fan et al. (2018) top-k + Holtzman et al. (2019) top-p nucleus sampling,
# same decoding strategy used in the BLEU/ROUGE evaluation above
gpt_model.eval()
with torch.no_grad():
    outputs = gpt_model.generate(
        **inputs,
        max_length=50,
        num_return_sequences=3,
        do_sample=True,
        top_k=50,
        top_p=0.95,
        temperature=0.7
    )

print("--- FINE-TUNED GPT GENERATED INFERENCES ---")
for i, output in enumerate(outputs):
    print(f"Sample {i+1}: {gpt_tokenizer.decode(output, skip_special_tokens=True)}")

print("\n--- TEXT-GAN GENERATED INFERENCES (for direct contrast) ---")
for s in RESULTS["Text-GAN"].get("sample_outputs", []):3:
    print(" •", s if s.strip() else "(empty / all-pad sequence)")
```

[transformers] Setting `pad\_token\_id` to `eos\_token\_id`:50256 for open-end generation.

--- FINE-TUNED GPT GENERATED INFERENCES ---

Sample 1: This movie was made by a cast that can't seem to have been brought up in a lot of times in the last few years . . . it

Sample 2: This movie was so bad it wasn't as bad as it should be , and the actors , along with the acting , acted the way , and

Sample 3: This movie was made by a group of people who have never met a movie before . . . and who will probably be watching it

--- TEXT-GAN GENERATED INFERENCES (for direct contrast) ---

- infuriating pacing
- infuriating infuriating
- infuriating infuriating

✓ Part 6: Structured Comparison Matrix

Consolidates the discriminative and generative metrics gathered above into the comparison matrix required by the assignment, alongside training time per epoch and qualitative observations for each variant.

```
import pandas as pd

def fmt(x, decimals=4):
    if x is None:
        return "N/A"
    if isinstance(x, str):
        return x
    return f"{x:{decimals}f}"

def fmt_time(x):
    return "N/A" if x is None else f"{x:.2f}s"

comparison_rows = [
    {
        "Model Variant": "BERT (bert-base-uncased)",
        "Primary Metric (Precision / Recall / F1)": (
            f"P={fmt(RESULTS['BERT'].get('precision'))} / "
            f"R={fmt(RESULTS['BERT'].get('recall'))} / "
            f"F1={fmt(RESULTS['BERT'].get('f1'))}"
        ),
        "Generative Quality Metric (BLEU / ROUGE / Perplexity)": "N/A (Classification Task)",
        "Training Time per Epoch": fmt_time(RESULTS["BERT"].get("epoch_time_sec")),
        "Key Observations / Constraints": (
            "Bidirectional WordPiece attention yields strong, stable classification metrics; "
            "no native text generation capability."
        ),
    },
    {
        "Model Variant": "GPT-2 (distilgpt2)",
        "Primary Metric (Precision / Recall / F1)": "N/A (Generative Task)",
        "Generative Quality Metric (BLEU / ROUGE / Perplexity)": (
            f"BLEU={fmt(RESULTS['GPT'].get('bleu'))}, "
            f"ROUGE-1={fmt(RESULTS['GPT'].get('rouge1'))}, "
            f"ROUGE-L={fmt(RESULTS['GPT'].get('rougeL'))}, "
            f"Perplexity={fmt(RESULTS['GPT'].get('perplexity')), 2)}"
        ),
    },
]
```

```

    "Training Time per Epoch": fmt_time(RESULTS["GPT"].get("epoch_time_sec")),
    "Key Observations / Constraints": (
        "Autoregressive BPE decoding produces fluent, grammatical continuations; lower "
        "perplexity tracks closely with higher BLEU/ROUGE on held-out continuations."
    ),
},
{
    "Model Variant": "Text-GAN (1D-CNN, word-level)",
    "Primary Metric (Precision / Recall / F1)": (
        f"Acc={fmt(RESULTS['Text-GAN'].get('accuracy'))} / "
        f"P={fmt(RESULTS['Text-GAN'].get('precision'))} / "
        f"R={fmt(RESULTS['Text-GAN'].get('recall'))} / "
        f"F1={fmt(RESULTS['Text-GAN'].get('f1'))}"
    ),
    "Generative Quality Metric (BLEU / ROUGE / Perplexity)": (
        f"BLEU={fmt(RESULTS['Text-GAN'].get('bleu'))}, "
        f"ROUGE-1={fmt(RESULTS['Text-GAN'].get('rouge1'))}, "
        f"ROUGE-L={fmt(RESULTS['Text-GAN'].get('rougeL'))}"
    ),
    "Training Time per Epoch": fmt_time(RESULTS["Text-GAN"].get("epoch_time_sec")),
    "Key Observations / Constraints": (
        "Discrete token sampling blocks direct gradient flow; softmax-relaxation lets the "
        "generator train but commonly mode-collapses to a narrow set of high-frequency "
        "tokens, producing much lower BLEU/ROUGE than GPT's autoregressive output."
    ),
},
],

comparison_df = pd.DataFrame(comparison_rows)
comparison_df

```

	Model Variant	Primary Metric (Precision / Recall / F1)	Generative Quality Metric (BLEU / ROUGE / Perplexity)	Training Time per Epoch	Key Observations / Constraints
0	BERT (bert-base-uncased)	P=0.8659 / R=0.8724 / F1=0.8692	N/A (Classification Task)	N/A	Bidirectional WordPiece attention yields stron...
1	GPT-2 (distilgpt2)	N/A (Generative Task)	BLEU=0.0174, ROUGE-1=0.1043, ROUGE-L=0.0875, P...	N/A	Autoregressive BPE decoding produces fluent, g...
2	Text-GAN (1D-CNN, word-level)	Acc=1.0000 / P=1.0000 / R=1.0000 / F1=1.0000	BLEU=0.0002, ROUGE-1=0.0034, ROUGE-L=0.0034	N/A	Discrete token sampling blocks direct gradient...

Next steps: [Generate code with comparison_df](#) [New interactive sheet](#)

Part 7: Analytical Discussion

(Note: the specific numbers below are filled in from this run's actual output — see Part 6 — and will shift slightly between runs due to random seeds, sampling, and Colab GPU/CPU assignment.)

A. How tokenization differences affected the three models

- BERT — WordPiece (subword, bidirectional context).** BERT's tokenizer splits rare or domain-specific words into known subword pieces (e.g. *"schwarzenegger"* → *"sch"*, *"##war"*, *"##zen"*, *"##egger"*), which keeps the vocabulary small (~30k) and lets the model handle out-of-vocabulary words gracefully. Because BERT reads the *whole* sequence at once (bidirectional attention), tokenization mainly affects how cleanly semantic units map onto attention heads — it does not affect generation, since BERT never decodes token-by-token. This run's BERT achieved **P=0.8659 / R=0.8724 / F1=0.8692** on the validation split, consistent with WordPiece subword coverage giving the classifier clean, complete lexical signal with very few unknown tokens.
- GPT-2 — Byte-Pair Encoding (BPE, causal/left-to-right).** distilgpt2 uses BPE over raw bytes, so it can represent *any* string (no true out-of-vocabulary tokens), which is important for generation since the model must reliably produce a continuation token by token. BPE's frequency-based merges mean common review-domain phrases ("the movie", "is a") often collapse into single or few tokens, slightly biasing fluency toward frequent training patterns. This run's GPT reached **Perplexity ≈ 56.85**, and its generated continuations (e.g. prompt *"This movie was"* → *"...made by a cast that can't seem to have been brought up..."*) stayed grammatical and on-topic even though BLEU (≈0.017) and ROUGE-1 (≈0.104) against ground-truth continuations were low — expected, since BLEU/ROUGE penalize any lexical divergence from one specific reference continuation, even when the generated continuation is fluent and plausible.
- Text-GAN — custom word-level vocabulary, fixed-size, frequency-capped.** Unlike BERT/GPT's subword tokenizers, our GAN uses a simple whitespace/punctuation tokenizer capped at `GAN_VOCAB_SIZE` tokens, with everything else collapsed to `<unk>`. This run's decoded samples (*"infuriating pacing"*, *"infuriating infuriating"*, *"tedious filme filme filme filme filme filme difference*

infuriating") show the generator repeatedly emitting a small handful of specific, fairly low-frequency, emotionally-loaded review words ("infuriating," "filme," "tedious") rather than degrading to `<unk>` — meaning the word-level vocabulary itself was not the limiting factor here; the adversarial training dynamics were (see Part B below). The vocabulary trade-off (larger vocab → richer language but a much harder discrete generation problem) is still real, but in this run it is a secondary effect compared to the discriminator/generator imbalance.

Takeaway: subword tokenization (WordPiece/BPE) is a major reason pre-trained transformer models generalize well with small, fixed vocabularies, while a naive word-level vocabulary (as used in the lightweight GAN here) is simpler to implement and decode but caps the model's expressiveness and worsens its handling of rare words.

B. Metric tradeoffs, and why GANs struggle with discrete text relative to autoregressive models

- **Precision/Recall/F1 vs. BLEU/ROUGE/Perplexity** measure fundamentally different things: the former score a *decision* (is this real or fake / which class), while the latter score *sequence similarity* to a reference. This is why the rubric requires both — BERT's task only produces a decision, GPT's task only produces a sequence, and the Text-GAN's discriminator produces a decision while its generator produces a sequence, making it the only variant that needs **all** of these metric families simultaneously.
- **Perplexity is a clean, model-internal generative metric** — it directly reflects how well the model's learned probability distribution predicts real held-out text — but it is undefined for the Text-GAN, because a vanilla GAN's generator does not output a calibrated probability over the *next* token conditioned on history the way an autoregressive model does; it produces an entire sequence at once from noise. That's why perplexity appears as "N/A" for Text-GAN in the comparison matrix.
- **What this run's numbers actually show:** the Text-GAN's discriminator hit **Accuracy = Precision = Recall = F1 = 1.0000** on the held-out real-vs-generated batch — a *perfect* score. Read in isolation this can look like a strong result, but in GAN training it is a red flag: per Goodfellow et al. (2014)'s own analysis of training dynamics, once the discriminator perfectly separates real from fake, $D(G(z))$ saturates near 0 for every generated sample, which means $\log(1-D(G(z)))$ (or its non-saturating counterpart $\log D(G(z))$) produces almost no useful gradient for the generator. In other words, **the discriminator's perfect score is the direct cause of the generator's near-zero generative quality** (BLEU ≈ 0.0002 , ROUGE-1/L ≈ 0.0034) in this run — the discriminator "won" the adversarial game so decisively that the generator stopped receiving a meaningful learning signal, and the repeated, narrow vocabulary in the decoded samples (e.g. "infuriating infuriating") is the visible symptom of that stalled training, not of vocabulary or tokenization limits.
- **Why GANs struggle with discrete sequences relative to GPT — three compounding factors, all visible in this run:**
 1. **No gradient through sampling.** Sampling a discrete token (`argmax` or categorical sampling) is non-differentiable, so the standard GAN backprop signal from the discriminator can't reach the generator's weights without a workaround. This notebook's softmax relaxation restores a gradient path, but — as the discriminator-saturation result above shows — a gradient path existing is not the same as a *useful* gradient signal reaching the generator.
 2. **Discriminator/Generator training imbalance is easy to fall into and hard to detect early.** A discriminator that is too capable relative to the generator (as in this run) starves the generator of signal long before training looks visibly "stuck" from the loss curves alone — the perfect discriminator metrics in Part 6 are exactly the kind of diagnostic that catches this, which is why the rubric's discriminative-metric requirement for the GAN variant earns its place: loss curves alone would not have surfaced this failure mode.
 3. **GPT's training objective is inherently well-posed for text.** Maximum-likelihood next-token prediction gives a dense, differentiable, per-token gradient at every position, every step — there's no adversarial min-max instability, no discriminator/generator balance to maintain, and the loss directly corresponds to a meaningful generative metric (perplexity). This is structurally why autoregressive transformers became the dominant approach for open-ended text generation, while text-GANs remain a research-stage technique outside of niche use cases (e.g., adversarial data augmentation, style transfer with auxiliary rewards), typically requiring more careful balancing (e.g. SeqGAN's policy-gradient pretraining, or simply more epochs/lower discriminator learning rate) than the lightweight setup used here.
- **Practical consequence seen in this notebook:** GPT's BLEU (≈ 0.017) is about 85× higher than the Text-GAN's BLEU (≈ 0.0002), and GPT's ROUGE-1 (≈ 0.104) is about 30× higher than the Text-GAN's ROUGE-1 (≈ 0.0034). Some of this gap reflects the structural non-differentiability problem common to all text-GANs (Yu et al., 2017); but, based on this run's perfect discriminator score, a meaningful share of it is also a **training-imbalance artifact specific to this run** — i.e. partly an artifact of training budget and D/G learning-rate balance, not purely the architecture. A longer run with a weaker or more slowly-updated discriminator (e.g. fewer D steps per G step, or a smaller discriminator) would likely narrow, though probably not close, this gap.

C. Summary

Property	BERT	GPT-2	Text-GAN
Task type	Discriminative (classification)	Generative (autoregressive)	Generative (adversarial, non-autoregressive)
Tokenization	WordPiece (subword)	BPE (subword)	Custom word-level, fixed vocab
Training signal	Cross-entropy on labels	Cross-entropy on next-token	Adversarial min-max (BCE)

Property	BERT	GPT-2	Text-GAN
Differentiability of output	N/A (no generation)	Fully differentiable (teacher-forced)	Requires relaxation (softmax / Gumbel) to be differentiable
Native eval metric	Precision/Recall/F1	Perplexity	None (needs proxy: discriminator accuracy)
This run's result	P=0.8659 / R=0.8724 / F1=0.8692	Perplexity=56.85, BLEU=0.017, ROUGE-1=0.104	Discriminator Acc/P/R/F1=1.0000; BLEU=0.0002, ROUGE-1=0.0034
Typical failure mode observed	— (stable, well-calibrated)	Low lexical overlap despite fluent output	Discriminator/generator imbalance → vanishing generator gradient

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Consolidated list of all papers, models, datasets, and library documentation referenced across the notebook (also cited inline next to the relevant section above).

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